

laid-out and comfortable to use. Voice Commander comes installed on the iPAQ 514, meaning you can go truly hands-free by using voice commands for commonly-used applications. Besides name-based number dialling, you can also voice-dial single numbers, that is, actually call out the number.

One attractive-looking phone, finished in soft matte black, the **Motorola A1200** has a very cool, translucent plastic flip cover over the screen. Like the ROKR E6, the Motoming a.k.a. the A1200 is Linux-based. Missing out on a keypad is never good unless the touchscreen is brilliant, and this is the A1200's first shortcoming—the touchscreen. We saw a lot of mis-registering stylus hits. There's very little space to type out characters, so composing SMSes is painful. Character recognition is not as good as WM or Symbian's UIQ. This mobile version of Linux definitely has its work cut out as a cell phone / PDA platform.

Performance

All the Nokia phones have good antennas, with almost no dropping in calls and reasonable voice clarity even in zone 1. The **E50** in particular excelled here, and is definitely the benchmark-setter in this category as far as this parameter goes. The **Sony Ericsson M600** takes fourth position overall, while the **HP iPAQ 514** brings up the rear (voice clarity in zone 1 became a problem).

Although none of the cameras on the phones in this category are worth too many words, the E50 comes closest to being near-acceptable. The image quality on the iPAQ is poor.

The Sony Ericsson M600's keypad is surprisingly usable—looks can be deceptive. The Nokia E61 and E62 are even better!

If you plan on using your full-time business phone as a part-time music player, you'd probably want to take a look at the Sony Ericsson M600. The E61 / E62 duo do reasonably well—just make sure to invest in a 3.5 mm converter and get a decent set of earbuds. Video playback, too, is great on the E61 / E62, courtesy their large, high-colour displays.

The two brick-like Nokias were also the snappiest while multi-tasking, while the Sony Ericsson was the proverbial tortoise. Thankfully, a firmware flash seemed to get its gears in motion.

The Motoming gave us decent signal reception in zone 2, but very mediocre performance in zone 1. It's also not as good as its multimedia-oriented sibling, the Moto ROKR E6, as far as multimedia playback goes.

With only two of these phones supporting Wi-Fi, it wasn't much of a comparison, but for the record, the E61 is a little faster than the iPAQ 514. Wireless browsing on both phones is acceptable—a sustained speed of 1.35 MBps should be enough for everything except heavy downloading.

Our Conclusion

The phones in this category deviate from the classical idea of a PDA. In fact, as our test revealed, these are simply business-oriented smartphones. The biggest attraction is their price—getting a full-fledged PDA phone for anything under 20,000 rupees is sadly still impossible. This is the next-best thing.

Flashy and gimmicky generally means a touchscreen. If you want a really nice form as well as flash-bling factors, then look at the Sony Ericsson M600. It doesn't have a camera, though.

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